

Why Does Delaware Ask for Total Hours and Weeks Worked?

Understanding Delaware PFML Reporting Requirements

If you've filed a Delaware Paid Family & Medical Leave (PFML) wage report, you've probably noticed two reporting fields that many employers don't normally think about: **Total Hours Worked** and **Weeks Worked**. It's common to ask why Delaware requests this information. A practical way to think about these fields is that they help provide a more complete picture of an employee's work activity during the reporting period. For most employers, this information already exists within the payroll or timekeeping system.

Understanding Total Hours Worked

A practical way to think about Total Hours Worked is the total number of hours an employee actually worked during the reporting period. For many employers, this generally means hours spent performing work rather than time away from work, such as PTO, vacation, sick leave, holidays, or other approved leave. Your payroll or timekeeping system is typically the best source.

Friendly Tip: If your payroll system tracks employee hours, you're probably already collecting the information Delaware is asking for.

Understanding Weeks Worked

A practical way to think about Weeks Worked is the number of weeks during the reporting period in which an employee accrued hours worked. If an employee worked any hours during a particular week, that week would generally be counted as a week worked.

Friendly Tip: An employee doesn't have to work a full week for it to count.

Quick Reference

Reporting Field	Practical Description
Total Hours Worked	Total hours actually worked during the reporting period.
Weeks Worked	Number of weeks during which hours were accrued.
Best Source	Payroll or timekeeping system.

Why Accurate Reporting Matters

Accurate reporting helps maintain complete employee records, reduces reporting corrections, and supports administration of Delaware's Paid Family and Medical Leave program.

Common Reporting Mistakes

- Leaving Total Hours Worked blank.
- Reporting scheduled hours instead of hours actually worked.
- Reporting every employee as having the same number of Weeks Worked.
- Estimating values instead of using payroll records.

Friendly Tip: Compare manually calculated values against payroll reports before filing.

Final Thoughts

Understanding these fields and reviewing them before filing can make Delaware PFML reporting simpler while helping reduce common reporting mistakes.

About Delaware Labor Reporting Specialists

Delaware Labor Reporting Specialists helps employers, TPAs, CPAs, payroll providers, attorneys, and nonprofit organizations understand and manage Delaware LaborFirst reporting requirements through practical guidance, responsive support, and real-world experience.

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